

Common Cyber Threats

- Malware and viruses target student devices through downloads and email attachments
- Ransomware encrypts files and demands payment for access restoration
- Social engineering manipulates users into revealing confidential information
- Account takeovers occur when credentials are stolen or guessed

Phishing Attacks

- Fake emails mimic trusted institutions to steal login credentials
- Urgent language creates pressure to click malicious links immediately
- Verify sender addresses and check for spelling errors in professional communications
- Hover over links to preview URLs before clicking on suspicious messages

Strong Passwords

- Use at least 12 characters with mix of letters, numbers, and symbols
- Avoid dictionary words, names, and common sequences like '123456'
- Create unique passwords for every account to prevent cascading breaches
- Consider passphrases like 'CampusLibrary2024!Study' for memorability

Multi-Factor Authentication

- Adds security layer beyond password to verify identity
- Use authenticator apps instead of SMS when possible for better protection
- Enable MFA on email, banking, and academic accounts immediately
- Backup codes provide access when phone is unavailable or lost

Safe Public Wi-Fi Use

- Avoid sensitive transactions like banking on open networks entirely
- Use VPN services to encrypt traffic on public networks
- Disable file sharing and auto-connect features before connecting
- Verify network names with campus IT to avoid rogue hotspots

Data Privacy

- Review app permissions regularly and limit data access unnecessarily
- Use privacy-focused browsers and search engines for better protection
- Clear cookies and browsing history after sensitive online sessions
- Be cautious about social media posts that reveal location or schedule

Daily Security Habits

- Lock devices with PIN or biometric when stepping away from desk
- Update software and apps promptly to patch security vulnerabilities
- Backup important files to cloud or external drive weekly
- Think twice before downloading apps or extensions from unknown sources

Key Takeaways

- Stay vigilant against phishing and verify all suspicious communications
- Use unique strong passwords and enable MFA on every important account
- Protect data on public networks and maintain regular privacy practices
- Build security into daily routines to create lasting protective habits